

strictly follow PEP 8. The important readability factor isn't which style you choose but consistency in using that style.

You can read PEP 8's "Naming Conventions" section online at <https://www.python.org/dev/peps/pep-0008/#naming-conventions>.

Appropriate Name Length

Obviously, names shouldn't be too long or too short. Long variable names are tedious to type, whereas short variable names can be confusing or mysterious. Because code is read more often than it's written, it's safer to err on the side of too long variable names. Let's look at some examples of names that are too short and too long.

Too Short Names

The most common naming mistake is choosing names that are too short. Short names often make sense to you when you first write them, but their precise meaning can be lost a few days or weeks later. Let's consider a few types of short names.

- A *one- or two-letter name* like `g` probably refers to some other word that begins with `g`, but there are many such words. Acronyms and names that are only one or two letters long are easy for you to write but difficult for someone else to read. This also applies to . . .
- . . . an *abbreviated name* like `mon`, which could stand for *monitor*, *month*, *monster*, or any number of words.
- A *single-word name* like `start` can be vague: the start of what? Such names could be missing context that isn't readily apparent when read by someone else.

One- or two-letter, abbreviated, or single-word names might be understandable to you, but you always need to keep in mind that other programmers (or even you a few weeks into the future) will have difficulty understanding their meaning.